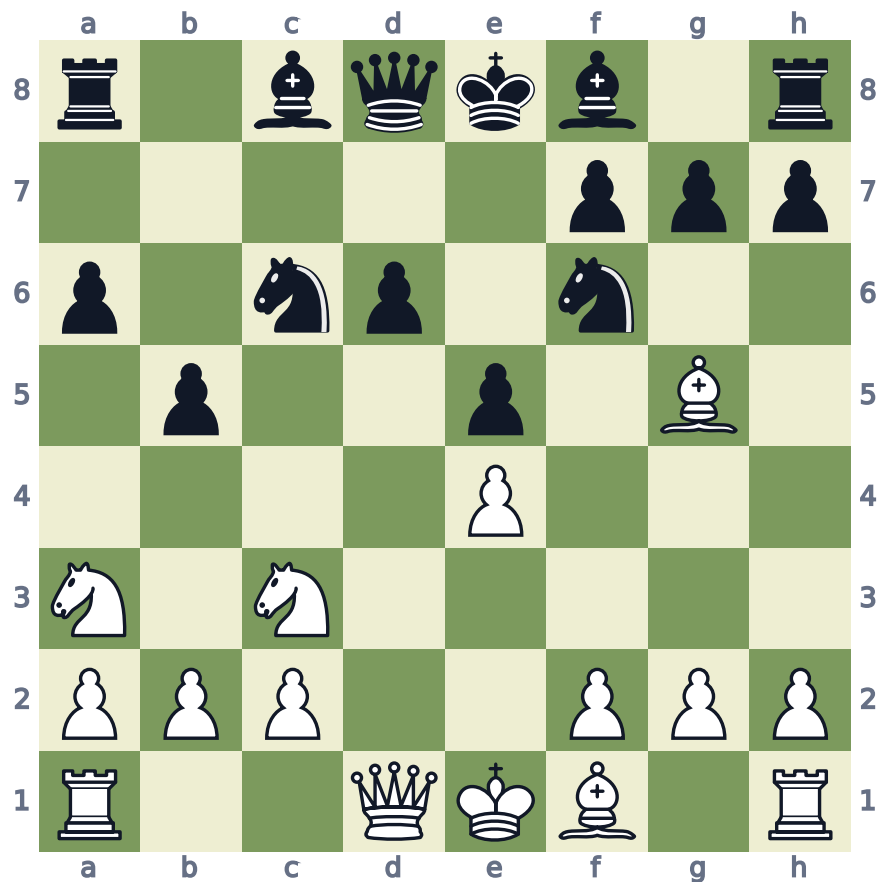


Open Sicilian: Sveshnikov, Classical, Kan, and Taimanov

Dynamic pawn weaknesses, flexible move orders, Accelerated Dragon ideas, and central breaks



Recognize the remaining major Sicilian structures and the strategic bargain each Black system makes.

8 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Recognize the remaining major Sicilian structures and the strategic bargain each Black system makes.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

The Sveshnikov accepts d5 weakness for activity and time.

PRINCIPLE 2

The Kan and Taimanov delay ...d6 to keep flexible central options.

PRINCIPLE 3

The Accelerated Dragon seeks ...d5 in one move.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

The Classical Sicilian develops Nc6 without committing to ...a6.

PRINCIPLE 5

A backward pawn can be acceptable when it buys active squares.

PRINCIPLE 6

Move-order accuracy matters because transpositions change tactical details.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

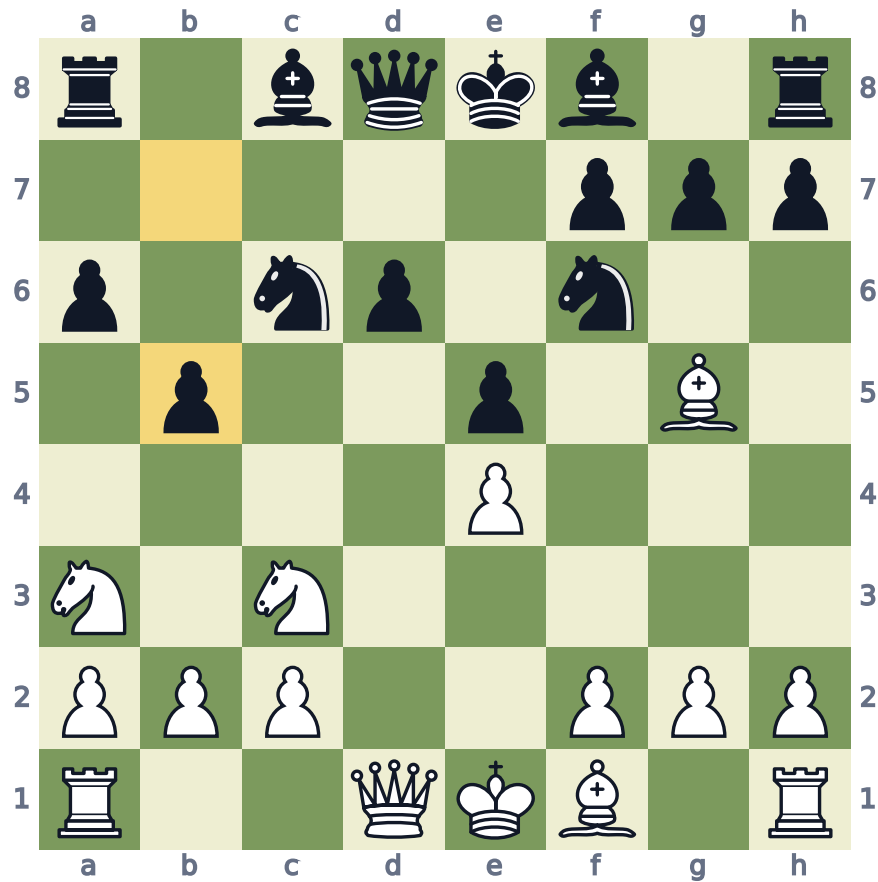
- | | | |
|-----------|------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Sveshnikov core | ...e5 drives the knight but leaves d5 permanently sensitive. |
|
 | | |
| 02 | Kalashnikov | Without ...Nf6, White can often keep more central flexibility. |
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 | | |
| 03 | Taimanov | ...e6, ...Nc6, and ...Qc7 identify the Taimanov. |
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 | | |
| 04 | Kan | ...a6 without ...Nc6 is the Kan's flexible waiting move. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | Accelerated Dragon | The missing ...d6 gives Black speed but allows c4 space. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Classical Sicilian | ...Nc6 without ...a6 or ...g6 keeps several Sicilian structures available. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Four Knights Sicilian | Four developed knights create immediate central tactics. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | O'Kelly Sicilian | Against 2...a6, c3 makes the waiting move less useful. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Sveshnikov core



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e5 6. Ndb5 d6 7. Bg5 a6 8. Na3 b5

WHITE'S IDEA

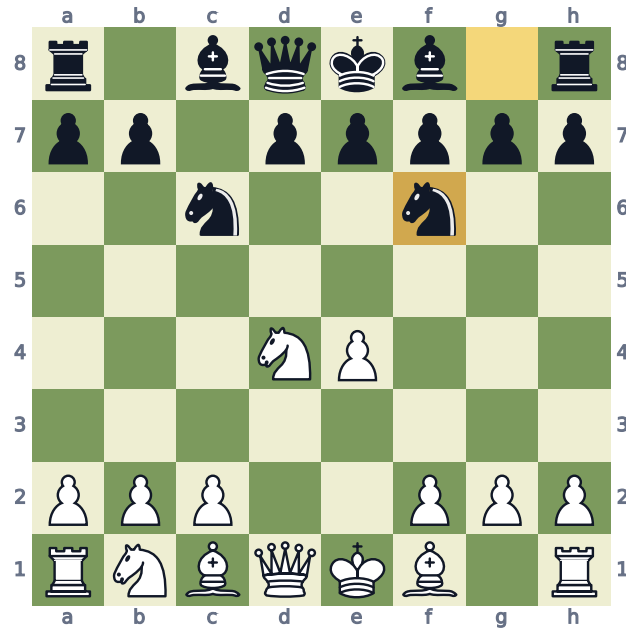
Use the d5 outpost and pressure the weakened dark squares.

MAIN DANGER

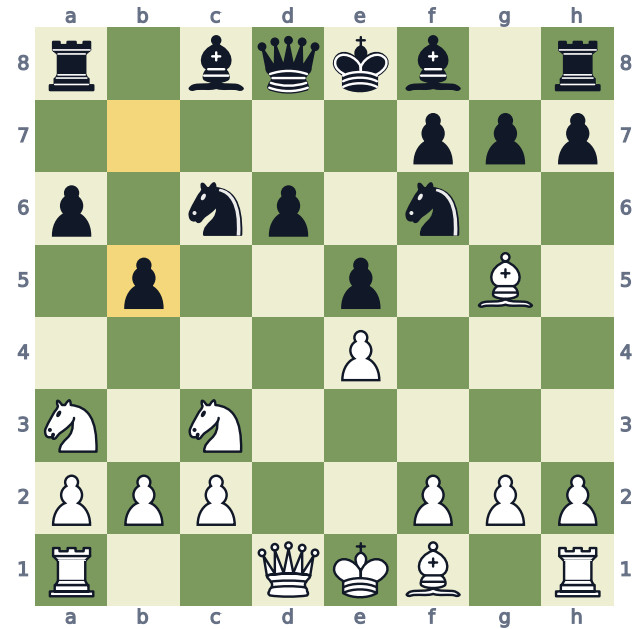
Black gains activity and queenside space with tempo.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...e5 drives the knight but leaves d5 permanently sensitive.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

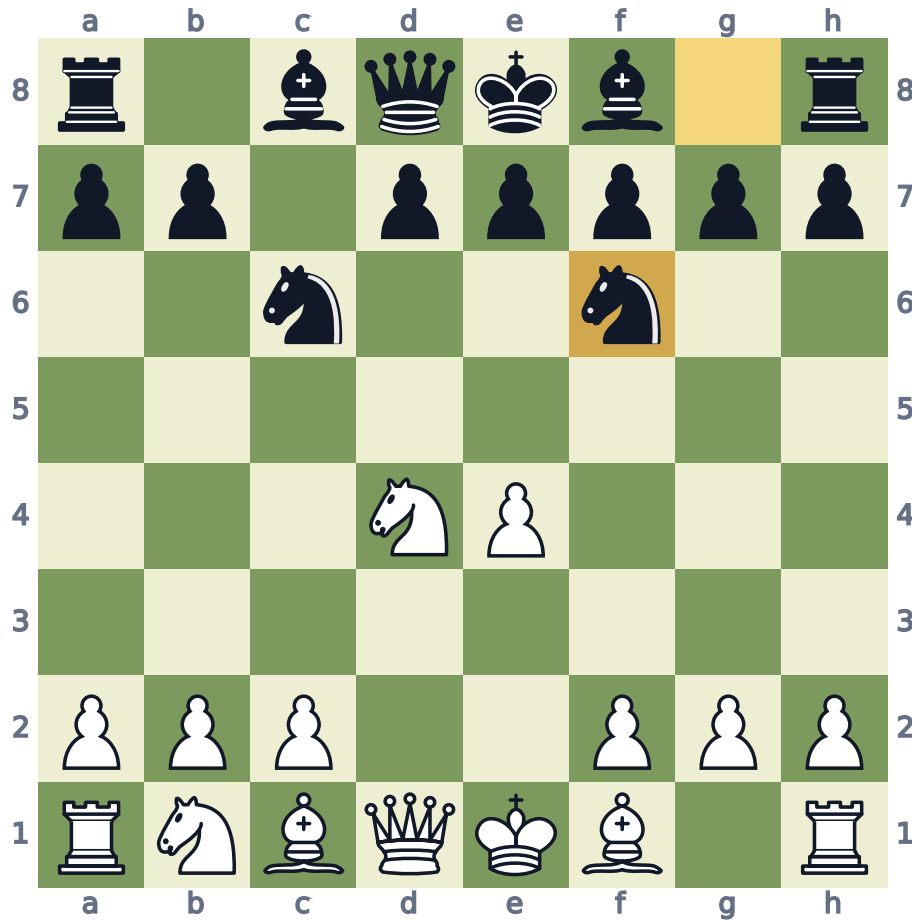
Position estimate: +0.48 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bxf6 gxf6 2. Nd5 f5 3. Bd3 Be6 4. O-O Bg7 5. c4 fxe4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Sveshnikov core



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Kalashnikov



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 e5 5. Nb5 d6 6. N1c3

WHITE'S IDEA

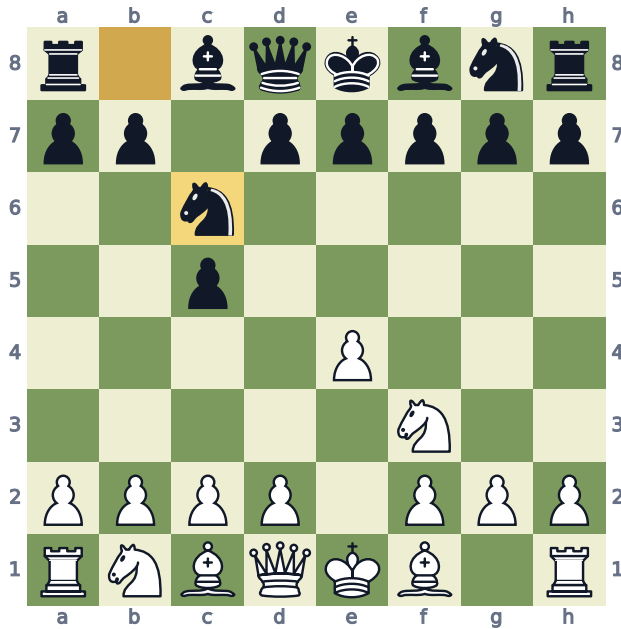
Use d5 and the lead in development against Black's early ...e5.

MAIN DANGER

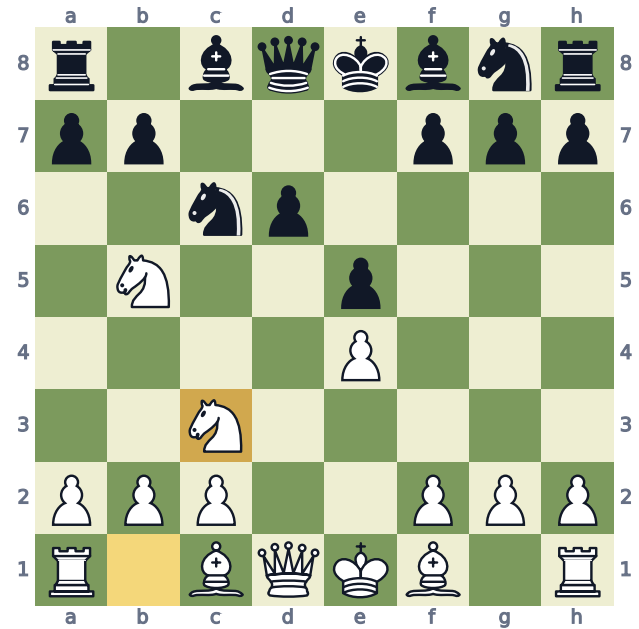
The b5 knight can be chased by ...a6.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Without ...Nf6, White can often keep more central flexibility.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

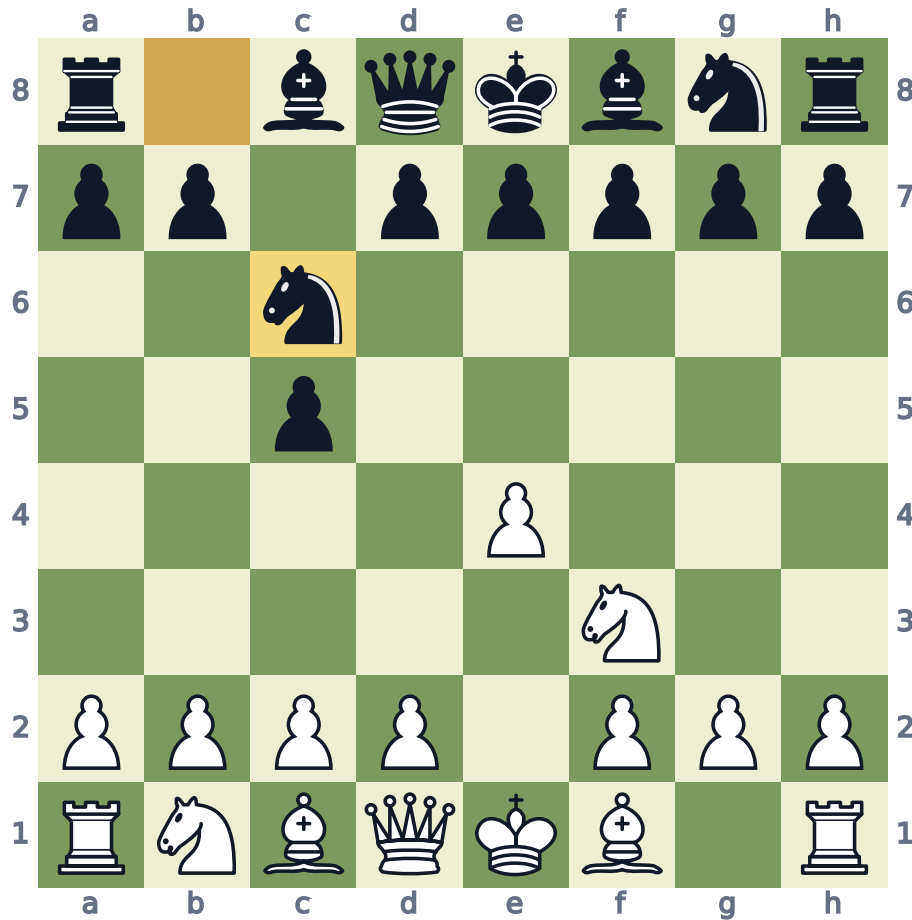
Position estimate: +0.32 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nf6 Bg5 2. a6 Bxf6 3. gxf6 Na3 4. b5 Nd5 5. f5 Bd3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Kalashnikov



YOUR TASK

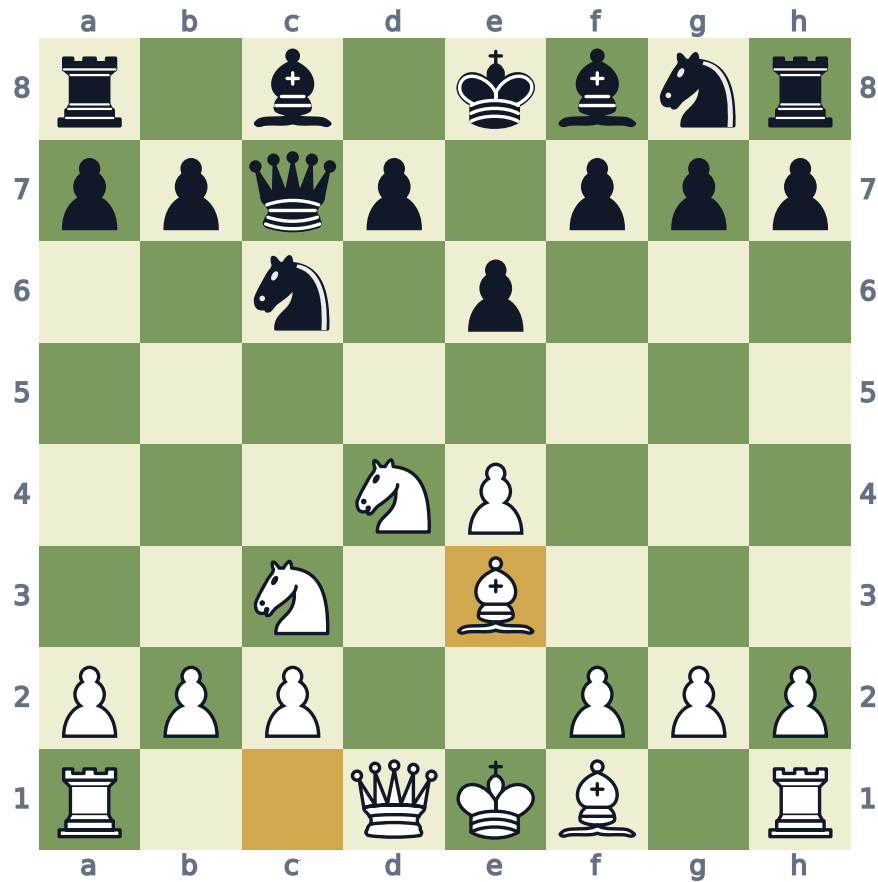
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Taimanov



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nc6 5. Nc3 Qc7 6. Be3

WHITE'S IDEA

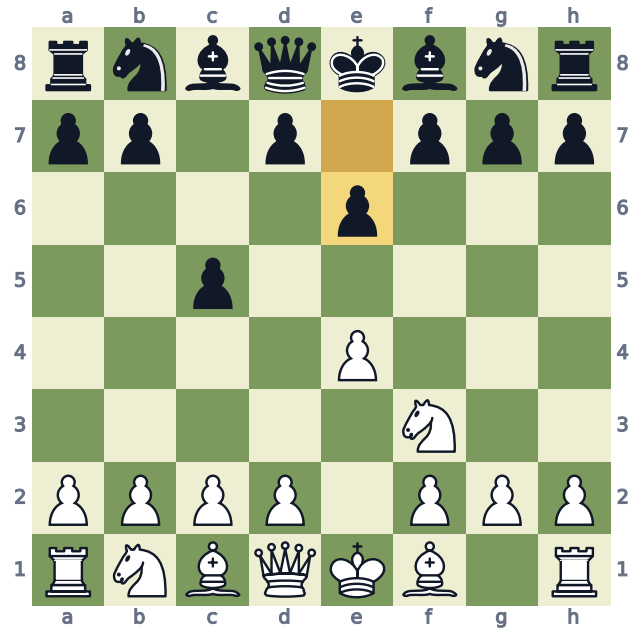
Develop flexibly and prevent ...Nf6 or ...Bb4 tactics from gaining time.

MAIN DANGER

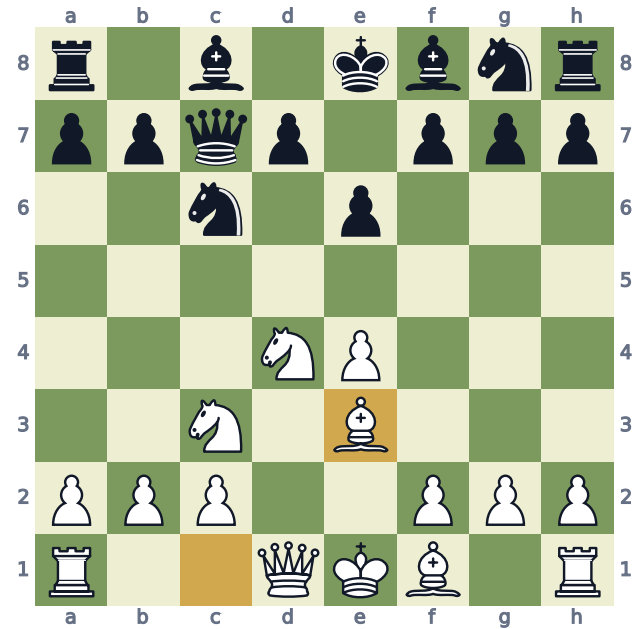
Black can strike with ...b5 or ...Nf6 depending on White's setup.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...e6, ...Nc6, and ...Qc7 identify the Taimanov.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

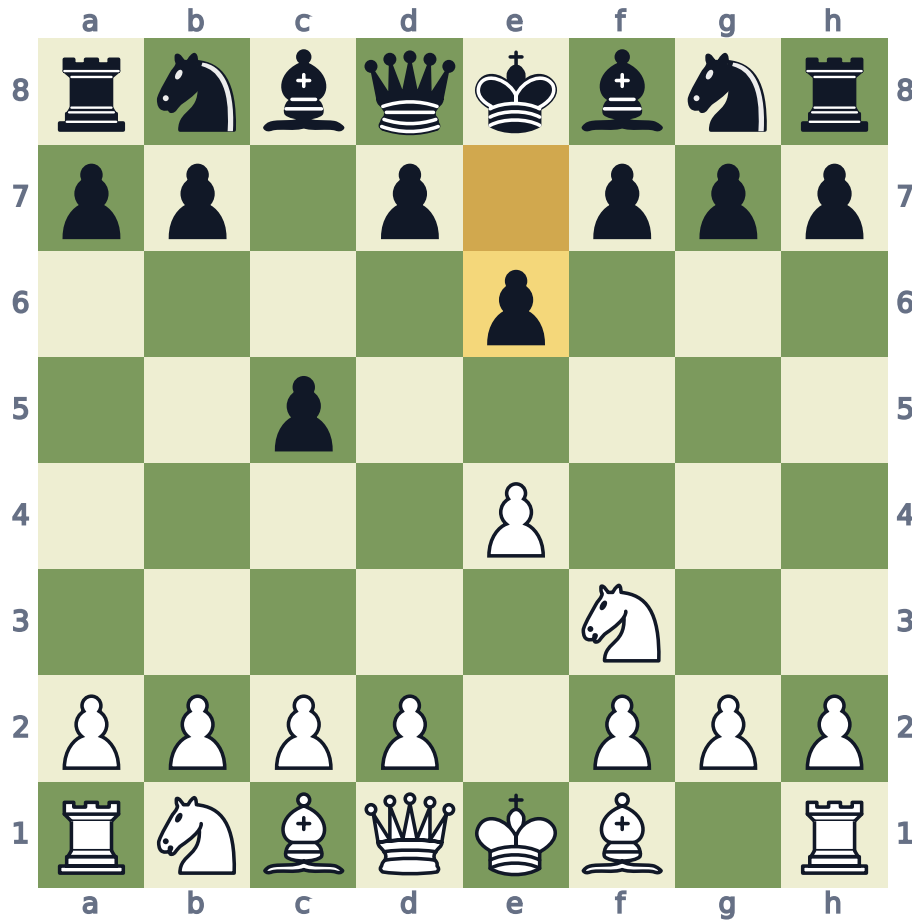
Position estimate: +0.51 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a6 Qf3 2. b5 Qg3 3. Qxg3 hxg3 4. Bb7 Nb3 5. Nf6 Nc5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Taimanov



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Kan



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 a6 5. Bd3 Qc7 6. O-O Nf6

WHITE'S IDEA

Use the space and lead in development before Black expands with ...b5.

MAIN DANGER

The bishop on d3 can become a target to ...Bd6 or ...b5.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...a6 without ...Nc6 is the Kan's flexible waiting move.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

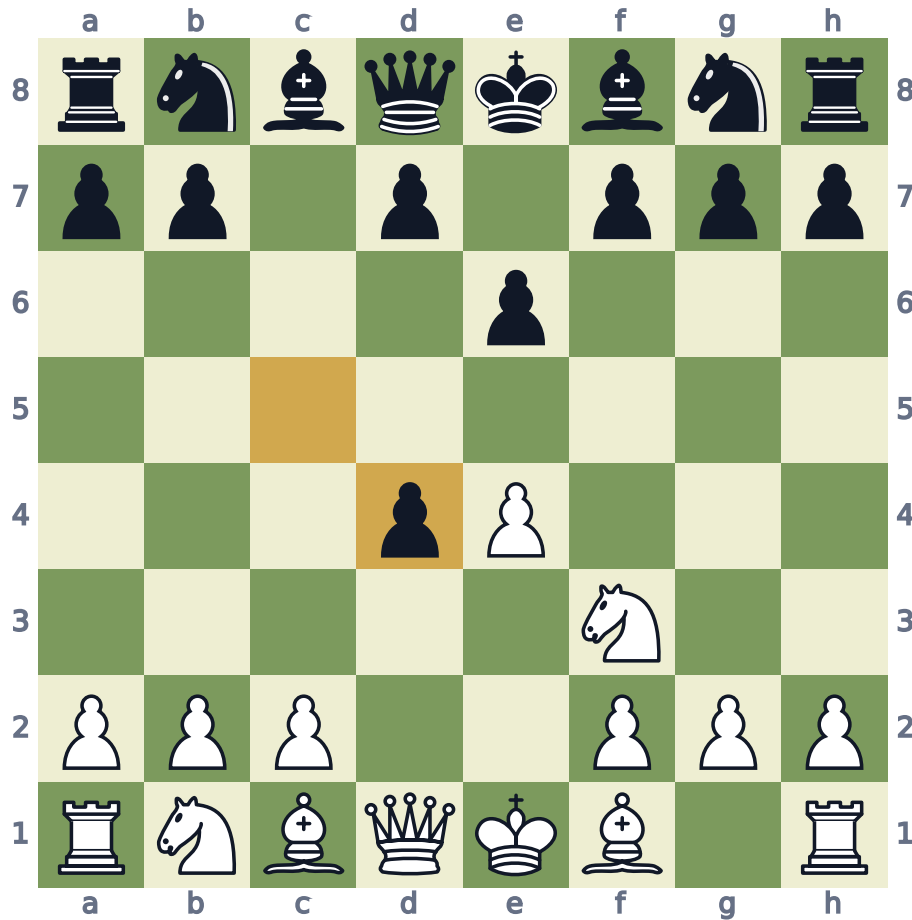
Position estimate: +0.53 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Qe2 d6 2. c4 Be7 3. f4 Nc6 4. Nxc6 bxc6 5. Nc3 e5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Kan



YOUR TASK

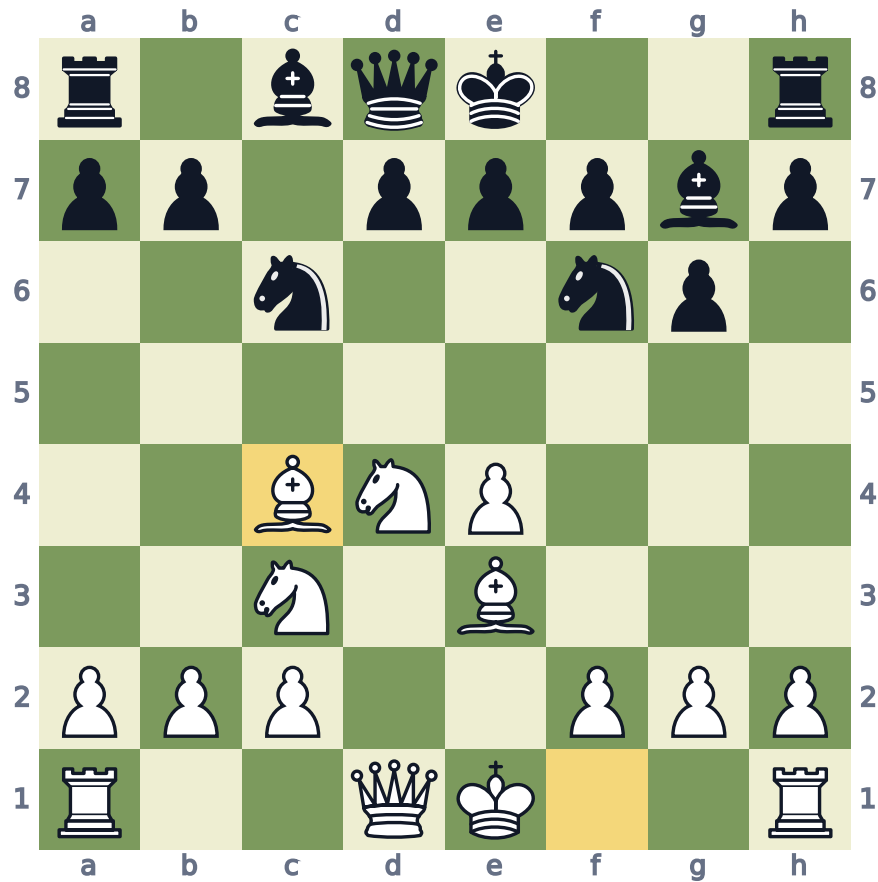
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Accelerated Dragon



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 g6 5. Nc3 Bg7 6. Be3 Nf6 7. Bc4

WHITE'S IDEA

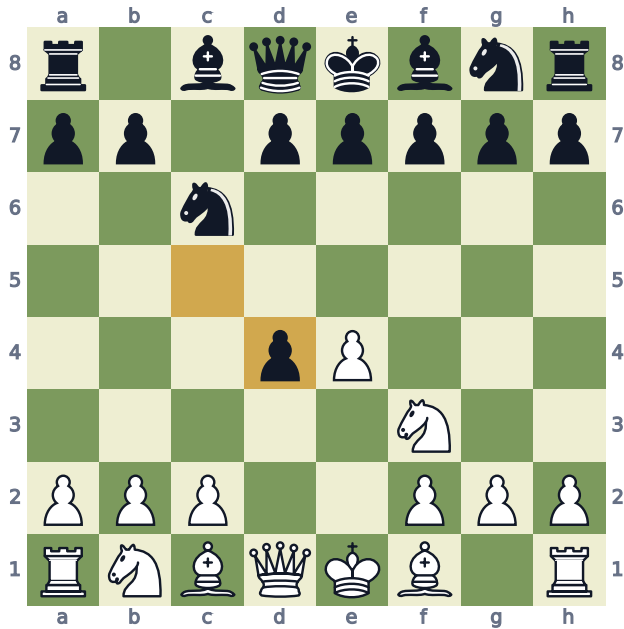
Control d5 and be ready for the Maroczy Bind with c4.

MAIN DANGER

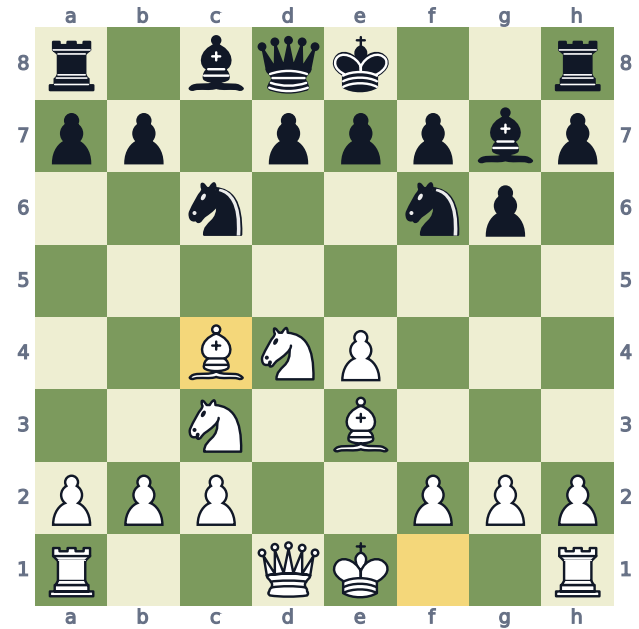
Black seeks ...d5 in one move and can equalize if it works.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The missing ...d6 gives Black speed but allows c4 space.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

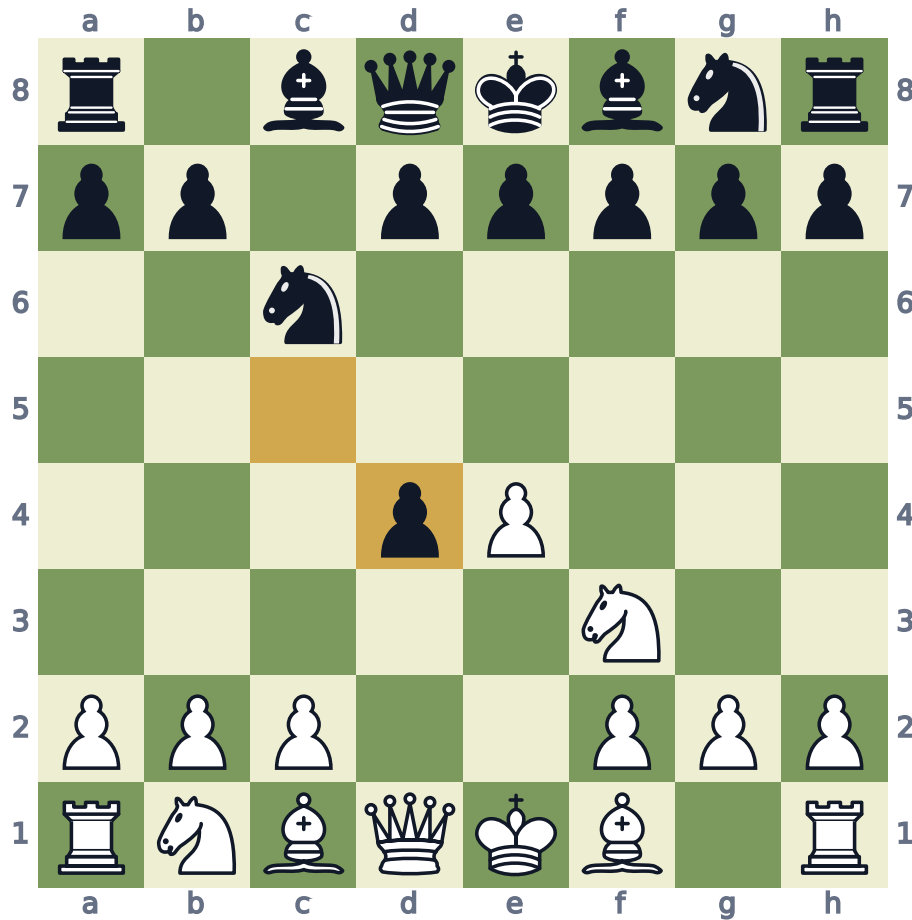
Position estimate: +0.21 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. O-O f3 2. e6 Nxc6 3. bxc6 Qd6 4. Re8 O-O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Accelerated Dragon



YOUR TASK

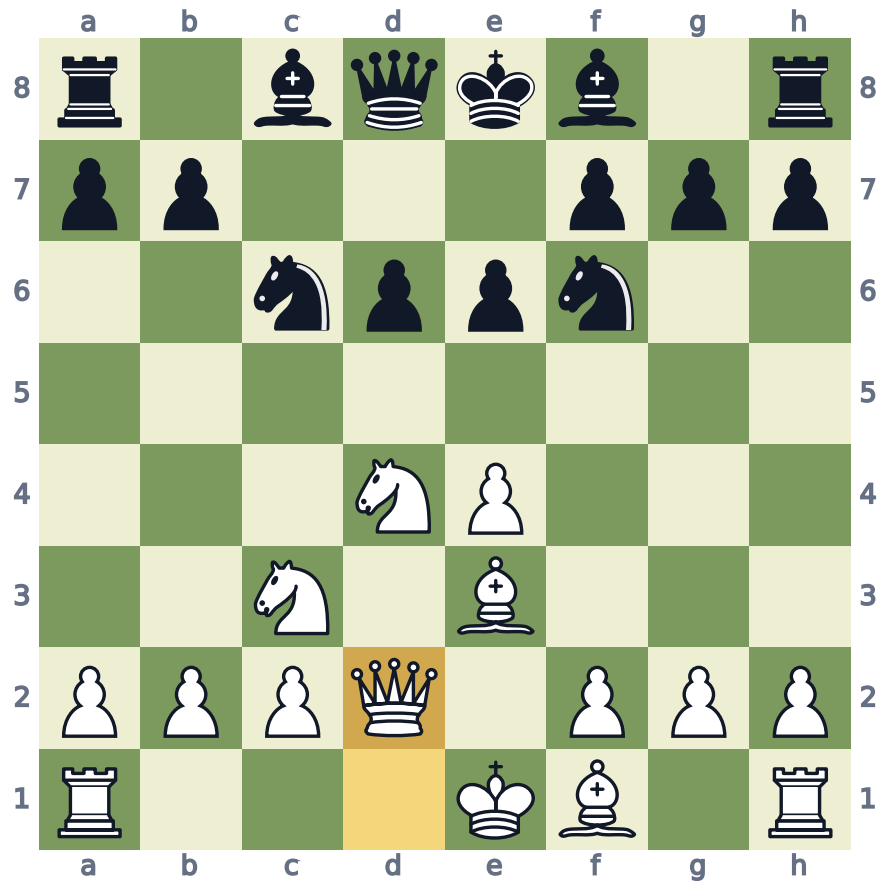
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Classical Sicilian



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Nc6 6. Be3 e6 7. Qd2

WHITE'S IDEA

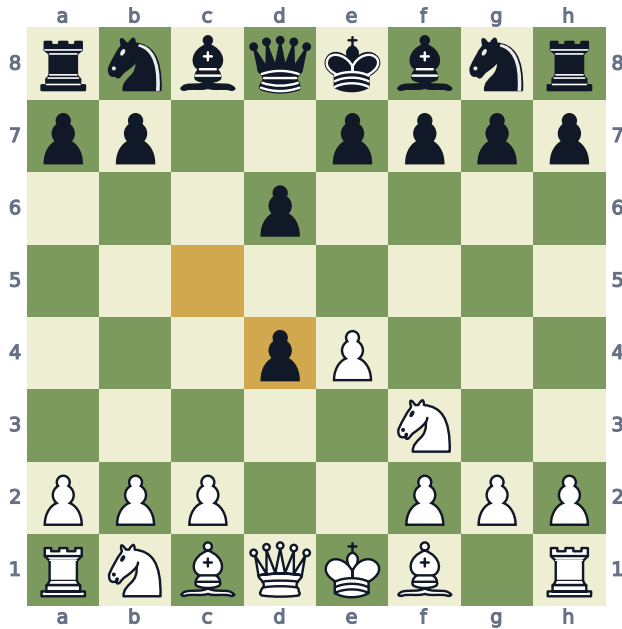
Develop for long castling while watching ...d5 and ...Ng4.

MAIN DANGER

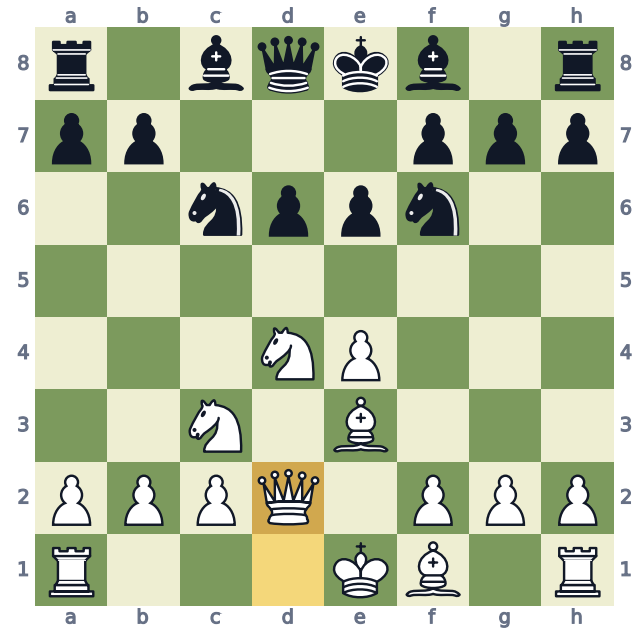
The c3 knight and e4 pawn can be attacked together.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...Nc6 without ...a6 or ...g6 keeps several Sicilian structures available.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

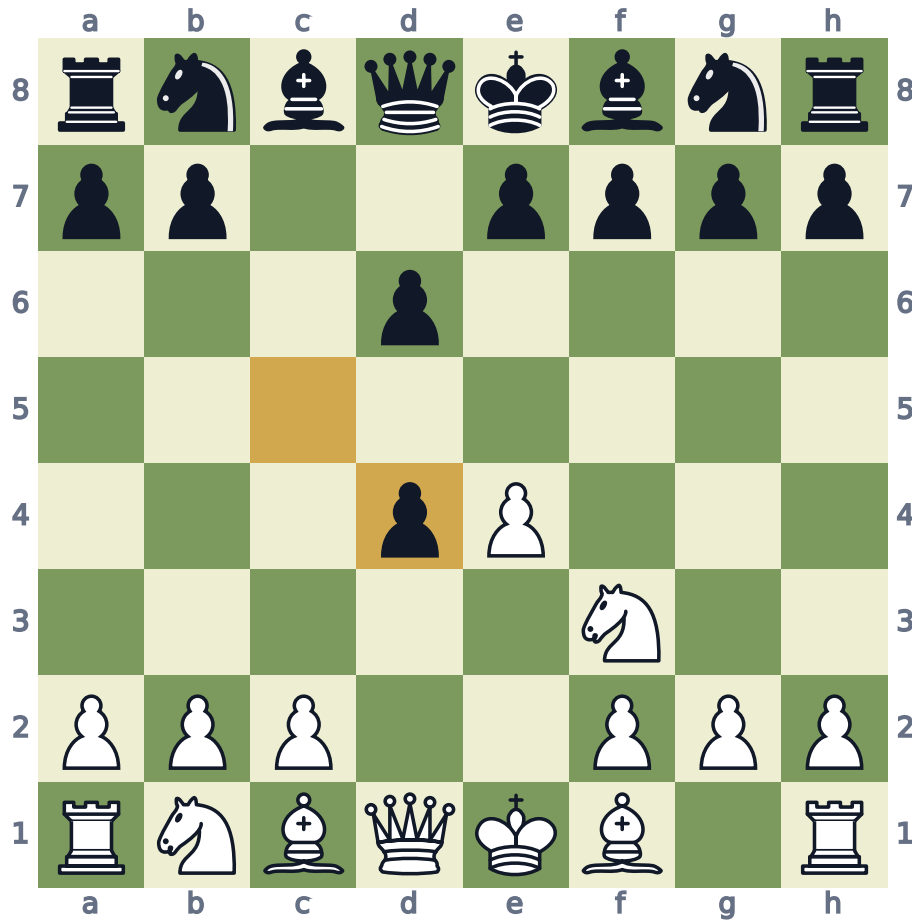
Position estimate: +0.61 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be7 f3 2. O-O O-O-O 3. d5 exd5 4. Nxd5 Nxd5 5. exd5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Classical Sicilian



YOUR TASK

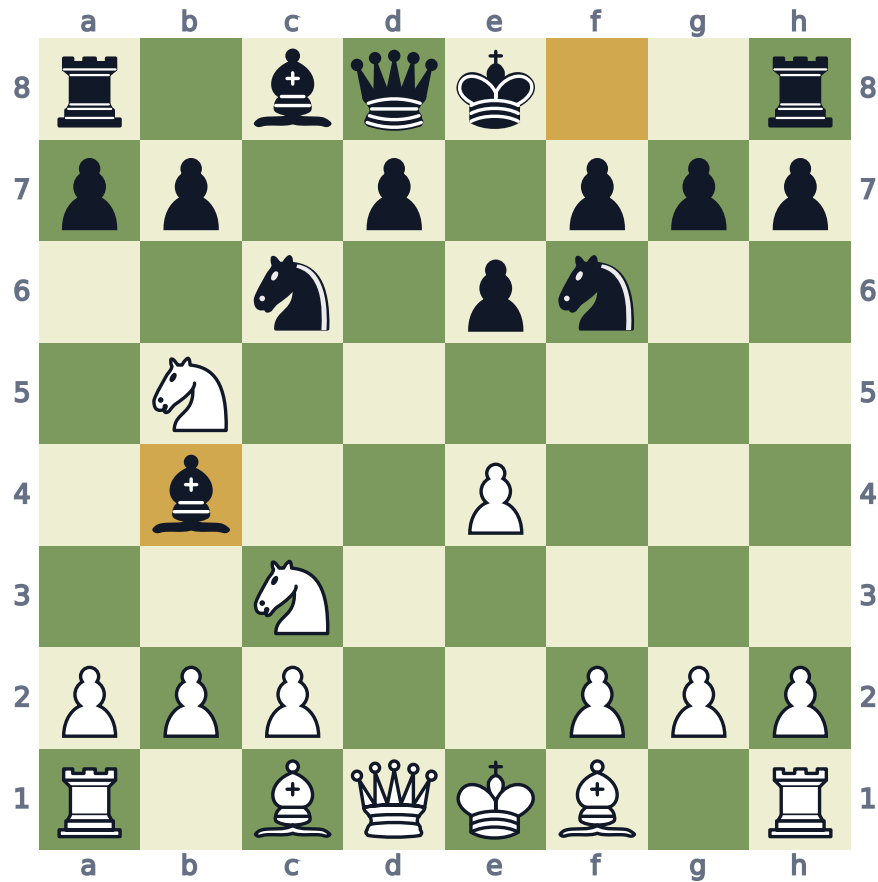
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Four Knights Sicilian



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 e6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 Nc6 6. Ndb5 Bb4

WHITE'S IDEA

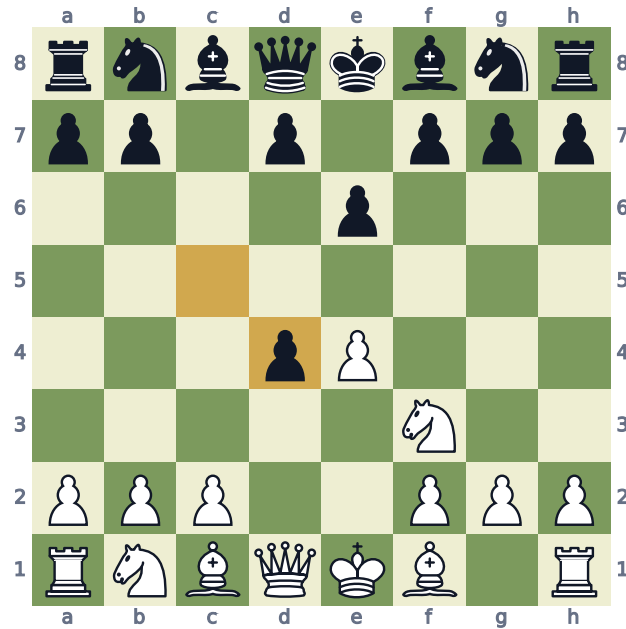
Use the d6 and d5 squares while meeting the pin accurately.

MAIN DANGER

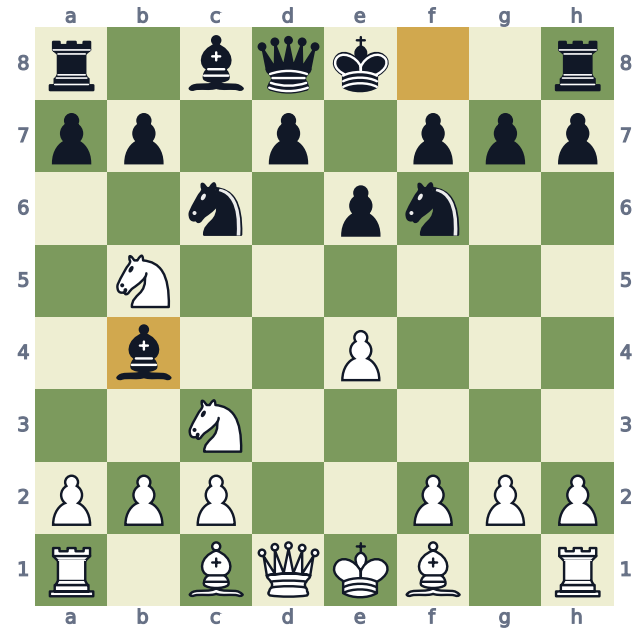
Ndb5 can expose the e4 pawn to ...Nxe4.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Four developed knights create immediate central tactics.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

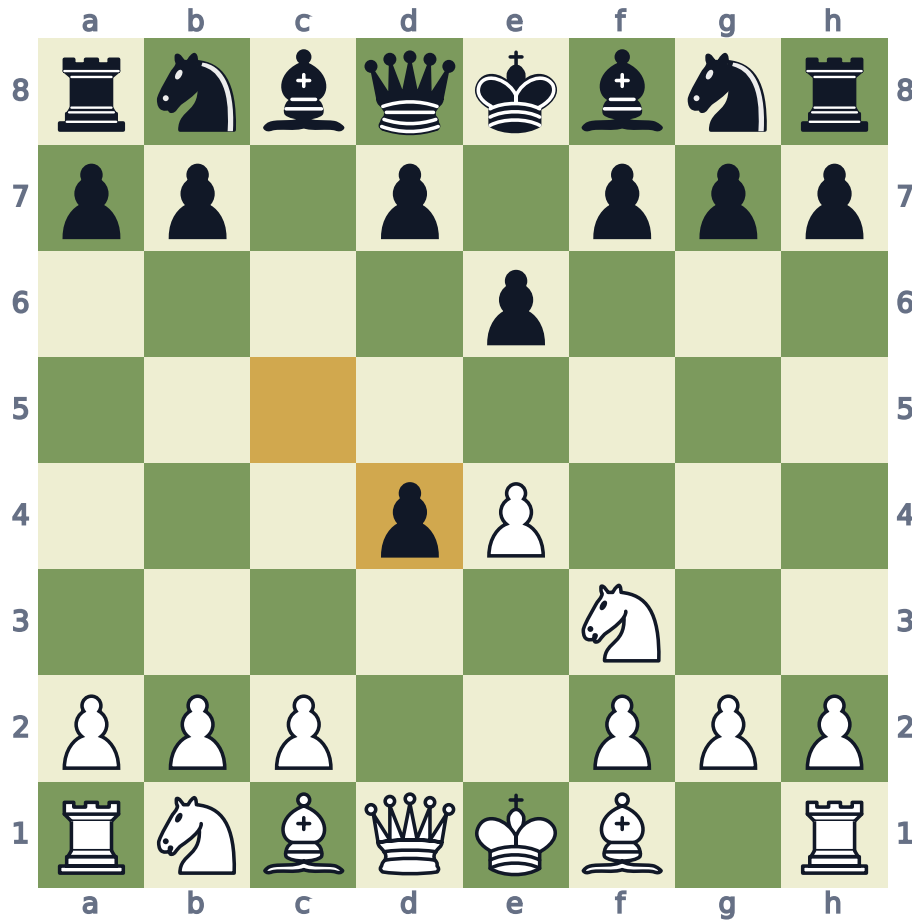
Position estimate: +0.47 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a3 Bxc3+ 2. Nxc3 d5 3. exd5 exd5 4. Qe2+ Be6 5. Bg5 d4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Four Knights Sicilian



YOUR TASK

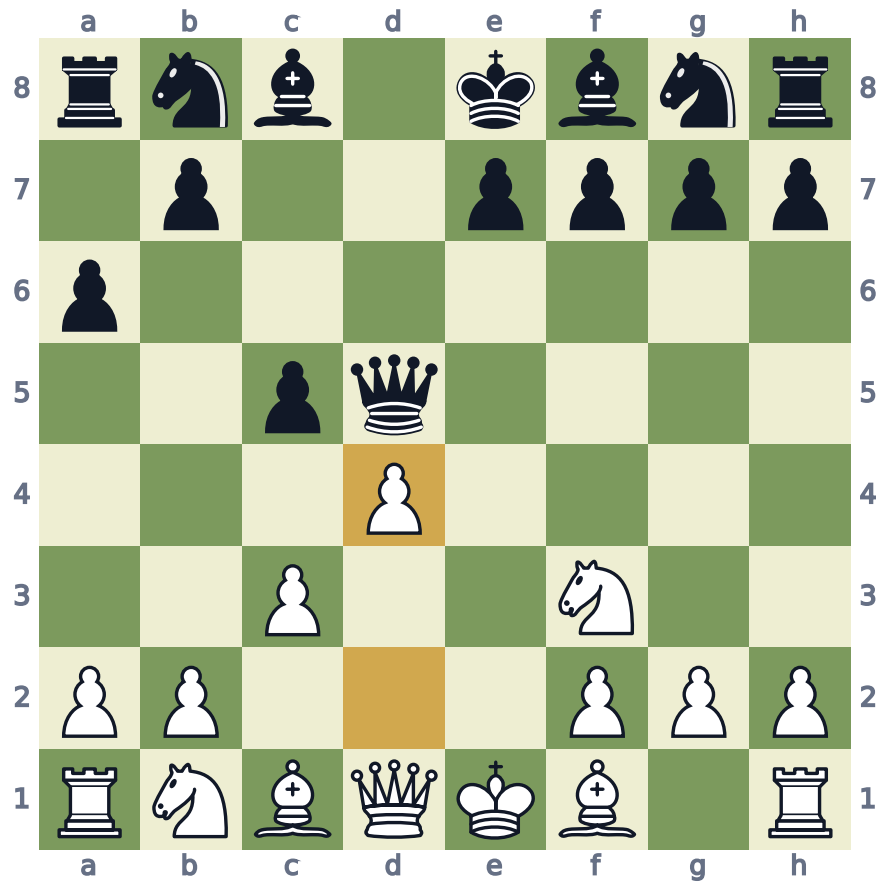
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

O'Kelly Sicilian



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 a6 3. c3 d5 4. exd5 Qxd5 5. d4

WHITE'S IDEA

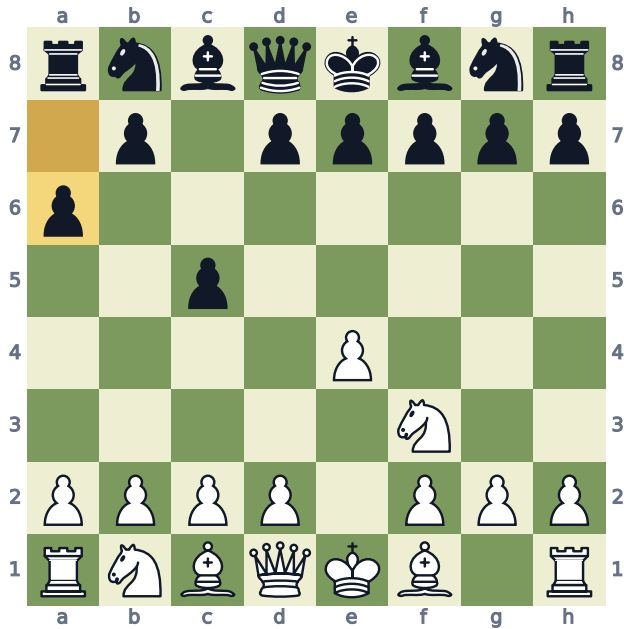
Exploit ...a6 by building an Alapin center without allowing the usual best move order.

MAIN DANGER

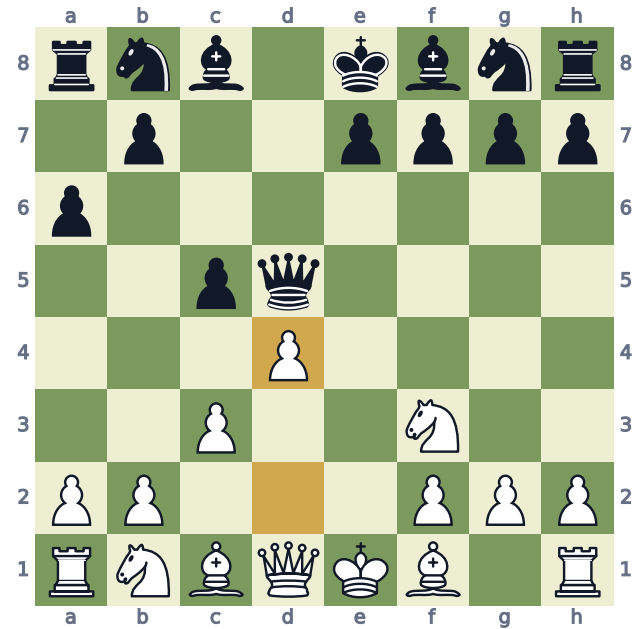
The queen can pressure d4 after exchanges.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against 2...a6, c3 makes the waiting move less useful.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

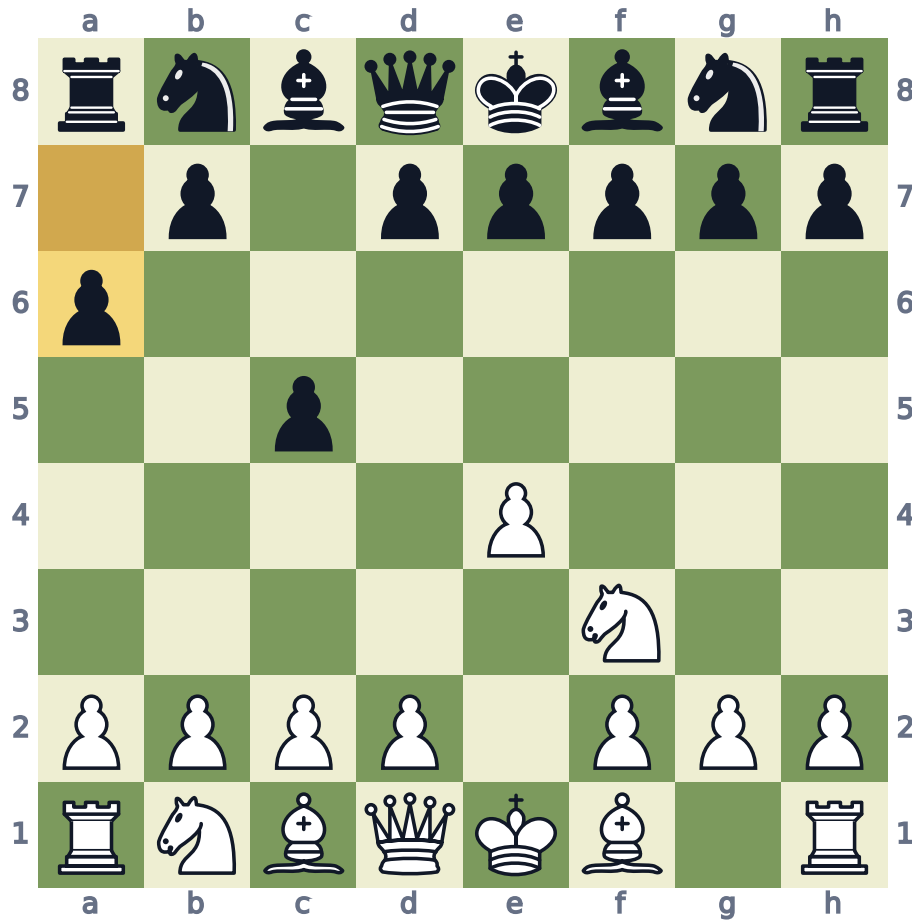
Position estimate: +0.53 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nf6 c4 2. Qe6+ Be3 3. cxd4 Nxd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

O'Kelly Sicilian



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. SVESHNIKOV CORE

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Use the d5 outpost and pressure the weakened dark squares. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 e5 2. Ndb5 d6 3. Bg5 a6 4. Bxf6 gxf6 5. Na3 b5 (+0.49 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black gains activity and queenside space with tempo.

02. KALASHNIKOV

Course move: d4. Purpose: Use d5 and the lead in development against Black's early ...e5. Engine comparison: 1. Bb5 g6 2. O-O Bg7 3. Re1 e5 4. Bxc6 bxc6 5. c3 Ne7 (+0.39 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The b5 knight can be chased by ...a6.

03. TAIMANOV

Course move: d4. Purpose: Develop flexibly and prevent ...Nf6 or ...Bb4 tactics from gaining time. Engine comparison: 1. d4 cxd4 2. Nxd4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Bb4 4. e5 Qc7 5. exf6 Bxc3+ (+0.50 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black can strike with ...b5 or ...Nf6 depending on White's setup.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. KAN

Course move: Nxd4. Purpose: Use the space and lead in development before Black expands with ...b5. Engine comparison: 1. Nxd4 Nf6 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. Bf4 d6 4. Ndb5 e5 5. Bg5 a6 (+0.38 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The bishop on d3 can become a target to ...Bd6 or ...b5.

05. ACCELERATED DRAGON

Course move: Nxd4. Purpose: Control d5 and be ready for the Maroczy Bind with c4. Engine comparison: 1. Nxd4 Nf6 2. Nc3 e5 3. Ndb5 d6 4. Bg5 a6 5. Bxf6 gxf6 (+0.34 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black seeks ...d5 in one move and can equalize if it works.

06. CLASSICAL SICILIAN

Course move: Nxd4. Purpose: Develop for long castling while watching ...d5 and ...Ng4. Engine comparison: 1. Nxd4 Nf6 2. Nc3 a6 3. Be3 e5 4. Nb3 Be7 5. f3 Nc6 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The c3 knight and e4 pawn can be attacked together.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. FOUR KNIGHTS SICILIAN

Course move: Nxd4. Purpose: Use the d6 and d5 squares while meeting the pin accurately. Engine comparison: 1. Nxd4 Nf6 2. Nc3 Nc6 3. Bf4 d6 4. Ndb5 e5 5. Bg5 a6 (+0.38 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Ndb5 can expose the e4 pawn to ...Nxe4.

08. O'KELLY SICILIAN

Course move: c3. Purpose: Exploit ...a6 by building an Alapin center without allowing the usual best move order. Engine comparison: 1. c3 d5 2. exd5 Qxd5 3. Be2 e6 (+0.53 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The queen can pressure d4 after exchanges.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.